

MAGIC BULLET AGAINST CANCER?

"The one proven magic bullet in the fight against childhood cancer is fun."

— Dr. Ira Gressman, Shaare Zedek

We all have to face it sometime. Old people, young people. Death plays no favorites. But the diagnosis of cancer to a child is particularly painful and bewildering.

Unlike an adult, children do not have the maturity, the ability, to properly process what is happening to them. Suddenly they are yanked out of all that is familiar to them—cut off from friends, school, and fun activities—only to face grueling and painful weeks, months, and years, of sickening radiation and chemotherapy.



In the process their hair falls out, they are nauseous all the time—along with numerous other painful and embarrassing changes to their bodies that cause them to recoil in horror at their own reflection. They have become transformed into a—
monster!

For most, this shame of being different and the need to cut off from all they know and love, is the worst part of illness.





For many children, this feeling of being different and the need to cut off from all they know and love, is one of the hardest parts of illness.



While life goes on for their friends... they must stay behind.



Hospitals become their world. Loneliness becomes their constant companion.



And for their parents, worry, exhaustion and fear become a daily burden.

HOW IT ALL BEGAN



When Lev Malka opened its doors in Jerusalem thirty years ago, it was charting unknown waters. No organization or branch of the health ministry was equipped to offer sympathy or help to families and children diagnosed with cancer.

One day, Rabbi Aberman was told of a poor, unfortunate boy, named Eli, who was recently diagnosed with a severe, unrelenting cancer—who less than two months ago lost his father.

As a result, his mother was unable to cope—not financially or mentally. She was close to a nervous breakdown.

Rabbi Aberman contacted the mother and offered reassurance and support.

I'm here for you. We'll get through this together.

He met often with Eli...

He visited him at home, in the hospital...

He took him on trips when possible...

...and helped the family as much as he could.

This was the blueprint of what Lev Malka would later accomplish on a much bigger scale.



It was evident to everyone that Rabbi Aberman's efforts were not in vain.

The isolation, depression and pain Eli was experiencing began to lift.



Eli began to smile again, to laugh again, to hope again.



The doctor noticed the dramatic emotional improvement.

The medicine the Rabbi dispenses is stronger than anything we can prescribe for his spirit.



No sooner was Eli on the way to remission, when other children with cancer came to Rabbi Aberman's attention.

Recommended by doctors or others who had seen Eli's transformation, one child led to another.



The need was clear. Suffering and pain were rampant. It was time to do more.

